

GOLFING JAPAN EDIT

Travel radio Australia and we're talking about Japan in this episode and my guest is a very special person Aya Kihara from the Golf Japan Company. Aya, welcome to the program. Thank you very much.

Hi, my name is Aya. We are looking forward to having all of you in Japan. Aya, a lot of people don't realize just how many golf courses there are in Japan.

There were literally thousands of them. Yes. Guess how many do we have in Japan by looking at the small Iran country? Any idea? No, tell me, but I would say, is it more than 1000? Yes, we do have over 2400 courses in Japan, which is number two in the world after U.S. It's a hell of a lot of courses and they're absolutely beautifully, meticulously maintained and beautiful.

And you're from Tokyo and tell us a bit about the Golf Japan Company. We are land operator in Japan who will look after you when you are in Japan. So we basically look after you the time you are alive in Japan till the time you depart from Japan.

So we're going to arrange accommodation, transportation, excursion, cultural experiences and golf. Tell us about some of the courses that you are connected with and tell us about those courses. Since we have over 2400 courses, we do have a certain connection to major courses, which is very open to non-member and non-Japanese.

They really welcome non- Japanese golfers and then look for providing a very comfortable services and, of course, beautiful courses. Are they in Tokyo or Osaka? Where are they? We do have a few around Tokyo because Tokyo is obviously two city. So there are, let's say, 45 to one hour drive from Tokyo.

There are tons of courses and then we do have around Osaka and Kyoto. And tell us about the accommodation that people can get via you. We offer several different ranges from the top luxury one to standard one, but still very comfortable, very clean, very safe.

Just the difference of the size of the room and location. I've been to Japan five times and it's a wonderful place to be and very welcoming. And I suppose in the north of Japan in the summer in Hokkaido, you have some gorgeous places there.

Yes, it is. In Hokkaido, they do have a very different two seasons. One is ski season, as you know, and another one is green season, which is the time for you to enjoy golf.

And then with beautiful landscape, which is different from the mainland, you will definitely enjoy. And tell us some of your favourite places. I know you're from Tokyo and can you give us some recommendations of places to go in Tokyo? Just because it's not just all about golf.

They can see restaurants, bars and tell us a couple of your favourite places. Around Tokyo, there

is a Kamakura, which is a very small traditional town, but you can get a very rich Japanese traditional culture and temple shrine with very good food. Other than that, you can maybe consider visiting Kanazawa, which is other side of Japan, with very good seafood and beautiful sceneries.

And the great thing about Tokyo is you can stay right in Tokyo. I mean, I stay in a place called Narita, which is the main airport city, and that is just beautiful within itself. And the links from Narita to the airport are very fast into the centre.

Yes, it is very convenient. You can just take train and it takes only 45 minutes to the centre area, but you can have a very good combination with the local area, Tokyo. Now, I'm speaking with Ayaki Hara, who is with the Golf Japan J.P., which is the website of the company.

And you can make sure everything is arranged for you if you are golfing in Japan as well. And they are really true experts in this area. And I suppose you have a fun time, Ayaka, because we're recording this in Kan, in France, on the French Riviera.

And you get to travel around the world with the Golf Japan come? Yes, I mean, as a travel agent staff, all our clients are all over the world. So we often travel to different areas, different parts of the world to see the new people. And what do you think of the French Riviera? It's beautiful.

It is very sophisticated, still friendly and relaxing. And, you know, I'm just enjoying. As I say, I'm a real Japanese fan and I have been skiing in Hokkaido.

And yes, it's very nice with my friends who run a big ski higher up there. Yes, if you are going to Japan, you must experience it some time. And if you want to combine it with golf, then the Golf Japan J.P. company is the people to do it with.

And I regard to Gozaimasu and thank you so much for being with us on the program. Thank you very much. It's a pleasure to see all of you.